ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** John Berryman	Berryman.
2	**(c)** play	Games.
3	**(d)** short	Short.
4	**(c)** ball	A ball.
5	**(a)** find	Lose x find.
6	**(a)** sad	Sad.
7	**(d)** water	Harbour.
8	**(d)** happy	Sad x happy.
9	**(d)** sorrow	Sorrow.
10	**(c)** sad	He grieves.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	John Berryman (1) an American poet (1).	1+1
12	The poet (1) from a distance (1).	1+1
13	It cannot remove grief (1) it is external (1).	1+1
14	His ball (1) in the water (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	The boy was playing (1). The ball rolled into water (1). He stood and cried (1).	1+1+1
16	A boy's loss (1). Growth (1). Acceptance (1).	1+1+1
17	The ball is round (1). Ships stay in the harbour (1). Both are nouns (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Sad (1). Helpless (1). Shaken (1).	1+1+1
18	Round (1). Bouncing (1). Lost (1).	1+1+1
	OR: One scene (1). One idea (1). Strong effect (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Boy plays (1). Ball falls in water (1). He is sad (1). Poet watches (1). He learns (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Loss (1). Comfort (1). Advice (1). End (1).	2+2+1
20	Young (1). Playful (1). Sad (1). Helpless (1). Learning (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Ships (1). Water (1). Boats (1). People (1). Noise (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that the ball is the main subject; it is a **symbol of loss** and the poem is about learning to cope with loss.
- Saying the poet will buy him another ball and all will be well; the poet says that **money cannot replace** the feeling of loss.
- Missing the idea: the boy begins to understand **responsibility** in a world of possessions where things get lost.
- Giving the wrong setting: the ball rolls down the steps and into the **harbour**, where it is lost for good.
- Mixing the poet: **John Berryman**, an American poet; the poem is in blank (unrhymed) verse with *enjambment*.
- Spelling slips: *responsibility, harbour, possession, loss, ball poem*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** balls	Add s.
2	**(a)** lad	Young male.
3	**(b)** watcher	Observer.
4	**(d)** lost	Lost.
5	**(a)** a	Consonant sound.
6	**(c)** water	At the edge.
7	**(a)** ball	A thing.
8	**(b)** America	American.
9	**(d)** bouncing	It bounced.
10	**(c)** stood	Action.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	No (1) he did not intrude (1).	1+1
12	Childhood (1) and things we love (1).	1+1
13	In the harbour (1) water (1).	1+1
14	About loss (1) and growing up (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He watched (1). He felt sorry (1). He did not offer money (1).	1+1+1
16	John Berryman (1). American (1). Observer here (1).	1+1+1
17	A line (1). Why (1). A feeling (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Money will not help (1). The boy must learn (1). Loss is real (1).	1+1+1
18	Deep sorrow (1). Sadness (1). Pain of loss (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Loss happens (1). Be brave (1). Help others (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	American (1). Poet (1). Born 1914 (1). The Ball Poem (1). Famous work (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Loss (1). Strength (1). Kindness (1). Value of things (1). Growth (1).	2+2+1
20	Address (1). Greeting (1). Poem (1). Feeling (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Toy (1). When (1). Feeling (1). Lesson (1). End (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that the ball is the main subject; it is a **symbol of loss** and the poem is about learning to cope with loss.
- Saying the poet will buy him another ball and all will be well; the poet says that **money cannot replace** the feeling of loss.
- Missing the idea: the boy begins to understand **responsibility** in a world of possessions where things get lost.
- Giving the wrong setting: the ball rolls down the steps and into the **harbour**, where it is lost for good.
- Mixing the poet: **John Berryman**, an American poet; the poem is in blank (unrhymed) verse with *enjambment*.
- Spelling slips: *responsibility, harbour, possession, loss, ball poem*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** acceptance	Moral.
2	**(c)** a new ball	He refuses.
3	**(c)** sad	Describes boy.
4	**(d)** verse	Lines.
5	**(a)** stand up	Be strong.
6	**(c)** port for ships	Port.
7	**(b)** water	At the harbour.
8	**(b)** loss	Theme.
9	**(b)** buy things	To buy.
10	**(c)** sorry for the boy	Sympathy.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A port (1) where ships stay (1).	1+1
12	Very sad (1) and helpless (1).	1+1
13	Sad (1) and thoughtful (1).	1+1
14	Learn to bear loss (1) and be strong (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Loss is part of life (1). Be strong (1). Stand up again (1).	1+1+1
16	find (1). happy (1). sell (1).	1+1+1
17	ball (1). harbour (1). grief (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A harbour (1). A boy (1). Water and a lost ball (1).	1+1+1
18	lost (1). stood (1). watched (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Listen (1). Talk (1). Stay with him (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Date (1). Game (1). Loss (1). Feeling (1). Lesson (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem (1). Story (1). Advice (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Meaning (1). Example (1). Feelings (1). Lesson (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Watches (1). Feels (1). No gift (1). Respect (1). Wisdom (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that the ball is the main subject; it is a **symbol of loss** and the poem is about learning to cope with loss.
- Saying the poet will buy him another ball and all will be well; the poet says that **money cannot replace** the feeling of loss.
- Missing the idea: the boy begins to understand **responsibility** in a world of possessions where things get lost.
- Giving the wrong setting: the ball rolls down the steps and into the **harbour**, where it is lost for good.
- Mixing the poet: **John Berryman**, an American poet; the poem is in blank (unrhymed) verse with *enjambment*.
- Spelling slips: *responsibility, harbour, possession, loss, ball poem*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.